

Isle of Wight Council

Heatwave Plan

2026

OFFICIAL



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FOREWORD

The Isle of Wight Council Heatwave Plan outlines the procedures and structures to be used by the Isle of Wight Council (referred to as 'the Council') in response to a heatwave on the Isle of Wight.

It focuses on the roles and responsibilities of the Council within a coordinated response with other agencies, including the Isle of Wight NHS Trust, Hampshire and Isle of Wight Local Resilience Forum, Hampshire and Isle of Wight Integrated Care System, and voluntary sector agencies.

This plan has been developed in recognition of the risks associated with extreme temperatures and fulfils the requirement placed on the Isle of Wight Council by national guidance.

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DOCUMENT CONTROL

The plan content will be reviewed every year by the Public Health Team in close consultation with the Emergency Management Team, or more frequently if required, subsequent to one of the following:

- Lessons identified from any incident.
- Lessons identified from any exercise.
- Significant organisational change.
- Changes to the Hampshire and Isle of Wight Local Resilience Forum (LRF) Community Risk Register.
- Changes in legislation or government guidance.
- Changes that affect the aim or scope of the plan.

Plan version	Changes	Date of amendment	Author
1.0	First version	May 2019	BH
2.0	Plan review and update following refresh of Heatwave Plan for England 2020	May 2020	CB
3.0	Plan review and update following refresh of Heatwave Plan for England 2021	May 2021	CC
4.0	Plan review and update following refresh of Heatwave Plan for England 2022	May 2022	CB/CC
5.0	Plan review and update following publication of the new Adverse Weather and Health Plan	May 2023	CC/NT/CB
5.1/5.2	Plan review and update following refresh of the Adverse Weather and Health Plan	May 2024	CC/CB
6.0	Final version of HWP for 2024	June 2025	CC
7.0	Final Version of HWP for 2025	April 2025	TP
7.1	Plan review following PH integration within IWC	April 2026	JS/IL
8	Final Version of HWP for 2026	June 2026	JS/IL

SECTION 1: INTRODUCTION

1.1 Background

The Isle of Wight is one of the sunniest places in the UK, with an average of over 37 hours of sunshine a week compared to the national average of 29.7 hours. With temperatures in the summer often exceeding 25 degrees centigrade, consideration needs to be given to this issue as heat has been linked to excess summer deaths.

Population exposure to heat is increasing due to climate change and this trend will continue. Globally, extreme temperature events are observed to increase in their frequency, duration and magnitude. Exposure to excessive heat has wide ranging physiological impacts for all humans, often amplifying existing conditions, resulting in premature death and disability.

Vulnerable groups that are particularly susceptible to excess heat include older people, the very young and people with illnesses such as respiratory and cardiovascular diseases. Because of this, there is a need to plan for these weather events and identify simple precautions that can be taken and how this will be communicated with the local community. Further information on the effects of heat on health is provided in [Appendix 1](#).

The Isle of Wight Council's Heatwave Plan sets out the Council's response arrangements to a heatwave as part of its service delivery. This plan has been prepared by the Public Health Team in close consultation with the Emergency Management Team (EMT) and has been updated based upon the [United Kingdom Health Security Agency \(UKHSA\) Adverse Weather and Health Plan \(AWHP\)](#).

The UKHSA AWHP aims to protect individuals and communities from the health effects of adverse weather and to build community resilience. It aims to 'prepare for, alert people to, and prevent, the major avoidable effects on health during periods of severe heat in England'. This is done by raising public awareness and triggering actions in the NHS, Local Authorities and other community organisations to support vulnerable people who have health, housing, or economic circumstances that increase their vulnerability to heat.

The AWHP was first published in April 2023 and combined both the Heatwave Plan and the Cold Weather Plan for England. The AWHP, which was published in March 2026, and considers other weather events that can adversely impact on health and wellbeing such as drought and flooding. It also considers supporting evidence regarding emerging hazards such as storms and thunderstorm asthma.

1.3 Aim of the Plan

The aim of this plan is to define the Isle of Wight Council's response arrangements to a heatwave in the local area.

1.4 Objectives of the Plan

The aim will be achieved through the following objectives:

- Define the circumstances when the plan should be activated.
- Define activation and notification arrangements.
- Define the Isle of Wight Council roles and responsibilities.
- Outline resident information and media arrangements.
- Outline recovery arrangements.

1.5 Scope of the Plan

This plan applies to a Heat-Health Alert which affects or occurs within the administrative boundaries of the Isle of Wight. The Council's Heatwave Plan pulls together the key responsibilities of the Council. It does not include other agencies' plans or Hampshire and Isle of Wight Local Resilience Forum (HIOW LRF) co-ordination which is detailed in individual or LRF plans (e.g. HIOW LRF Emergency Response arrangements or the Island Death Management Handbook). This plan does not replace Council service level plans and in-house business continuity plans, which remain central to the local area response.

1.6 Security classification

This document has been given the security classification of '**OFFICIAL**' as the author of this document has assessed this as an official document but does not require the higher level of 'OFFICIAL SENSITIVE'.

1.7 Linked Plans

The Council's Heatwave Plan could be activated as part of a wider response to an adverse weather event. The Council's Severe Weather Arrangements Document (SWAD) sets out response and recovery actions and considerations for the wider consequence management of weather impacts.

Depending on the severity of the weather event both the Heatwave Plan and the SWAD could be activated alongside the Council's [Emergency Response and Recovery Plan \(ERRP\)](#), which sets out the Council response and recovery structures that may be enacted.

During severe weather events, there may be broader consequences arising such as reduced access to water, fires etc. In the case of these specific circumstances, please refer to standalone resilience plans.

SECTION 2: HEAT-HEALTH ALERTS

2.1 Types of Heat Alert Systems

In England there are two early warning systems related to high temperature, the UKHSA Heat-Health Alerts (HHA) and the National Severe Weather Warning Service (NSWWS) Extreme Heat (EH) warnings. Since summer 2021 UKHSA and the Met Office have collaborated to ensure that the HHA and EH warnings are aligned and work together to communicate the expected impacts so that users act to minimise the potential impact. Each system has a slightly different target audience yet both work together to help focus on the messages being transmitted.

The alert systems operate in England between 1 June and 30 September each year, during which time [UKHSA Heat-Health Alerts](#) and Met Office Extreme Heat Alerts are issued. The two different alert systems are summarised in Table 1. It should be noted that the HHA and NSWWS EH system are both separate to the Met Office Heatwave Definition which can be found here: [What is a heatwave? - Met Office.](#)

Heat Alert System	Purpose	Location of operation	Threshold	Action	Audience
UKHSA Heat-Health Alert	Indicate potential health-sector impacts and likelihood of those impacts occurring based on the forecast temperatures	England only	Impact-based (Green, Yellow, Amber and Red alerts)	Follow NHS/health service action plans	England only health & social care sectors, public etc.
Met Office National Severe Weather Warning Service - Extreme Heat	To increase awareness of the negative impacts of extreme heat on health, infrastructure and other services. Impacts expected to be many and varied, e.g. increased coastal traffic, added strain on health service.	UK wide	Impact-based (Amber and Red alerts) ¹	Plan for extreme heat, take steps to stay cool. Civil Contingency advisors support Government / business	UK wide – Government, civil contingency advisors, business, public etc.

Table 1: Summary of the different Heat Alert Systems in place

¹ A Met Office Amber or Red Extreme Heat warning is issued for the highest level events (indicating Medium or High likelihood of Medium or High impacts) with expected impacts on the general population and disruption to infrastructure.

SECTION 3: NOTIFICATION OF HEAT-HEALTH ALERTS, ESCALATION AND STAND DOWN

3.1 Notification of Alerts

The Met Office provides email alerts about the risk of a heatwave, identifying the particular UKHSA Heat-Health alert level. An Extreme Heat Warning may also be issued from 1 June.

The following will receive the alerts within the Isle of Wight Council:

- Public Health (PH) assigned team members.
- Isle of Wight Council Emergency Management Team.
- Communications team.
- Individual departments who have signed up to receive alerts directly from the Met Office using the following link: [Weather-Health Alerting system registration form \(office.com\)](#)

3.2 Cascading of Alerts

The Emergency Management Duty Officer (EMDO) will cascade all received alerts by email to:

- The Council's senior duty officer
- Public Health Team – Director of Public Health, Consultant in Public Health with lead for emergency planning, designated Health Protection contact, and IOW Public Health Service Manager
- Nominated team members from each local authority department

A distribution list (EM - extreme temperatures) has been set up in collaboration with team members from across the Council. The distribution list is centrally managed by the Council's Digital and ICT Service. It will be reviewed annually to reflect service changes within the Council.

[Appendix 2](#) and [Appendix 3](#) provide examples of the text included in the yellow, amber and red heat-health alert notifications cascaded by the EMDO. The responsible internal LA departments notify and advise their staff and the following organisations:

- Social Services
- Day Care services
- Residential and children's homes
- Schools and nurseries
- Family centres
- Additional voluntary sector organisations
- Nursing and care homes

3.3 Isle of Wight Council Action

To describe the response required by the Isle of Wight Council, five levels have been identified which correspond to the Heat-Health Alerts (HHA) in the UKHSA AWWP and actions in the AWWP [Hot weather and health action cards](#). These response levels are illustrated in Table 2.

UKHSA AWWP Heat-Health Alert	IWC Response Level	Possible Impacts	Isle of Wight Council Actions
Green (preparedness)	1	Heatwave and summer preparedness programme: 1 June – 30 September. No alert will be issued as the conditions are likely to have minimal impact on health Long-term planning: all year-round planning to reduce the impact of climate change and ensure maximum adaptation to reduce harm from heatwaves. This emphasises that year-round planning is required to build resilience and reduce the impact of hot weather.	Business as usual and summer planning and preparedness activities. This level of alert relates to those longer-term actions that reduce the harm to health of hot weather when it occurs (e.g. housing and energy efficiency measures, and long-term sustainable approaches to influence behaviour change across health and social care professionals, communities and individuals and to mitigate for the effects of climate change).
Yellow (response)	2	These alerts cover a range of situations. Yellow alerts may be issued during periods of heat which would be unlikely to impact most people but could impact those who are particularly vulnerable.	Cascade alert. Raise awareness among Council staff and residents and consider impact on the vulnerable.
Amber (enhanced response)	3	An amber alert indicates that weather impacts are likely to be felt across the whole health service, with potential for the whole population to be at risk. Non-health sectors may also start to observe impacts and a more significant coordinated response may be required.	As per level 2 but consider need to enhance public messaging on risks. Consideration should also be given to reviewing safety at public events. Director of Public Health to risk assess impact on the local population, in conjunction with UKHSA where necessary, and will liaise with EMT to consider standing up the Council's Silver group. Risk assessment should consider not only heat alerts, but concurrent Island events and

			ongoing situations. At this level a multi-agency teleconference could be initiated by any agency. (see Section 3.3.1)
Red (emergency response)	4	At this level illness and death may occur among the fit and healthy and not just high-risk groups.	As per level 3. The Council would establish its internal command structure and a Senior Officer would represent the Council at multi-agency meetings to ensure the safeguarding of Council interests and to discuss any mutual aid the Council may be able to offer to health or other colleagues.
N/A	5		Stand Down and Recovery activities (see section 3.4)

Table 2: IWC Heatwave Plan levels of response
3.3.1 Isle of Wight Council Response Arrangements

For amber and red HHAs, a risk assessment undertaken by the DPH and/or their deputies will be discussed with the EMT and a decision taken to activate the Council's internal command and control arrangements as defined in the Council's [Emergency Response and Recovery Plan \(ERRP\)](#). This plan focuses on the roles and responsibilities of the Council and describes the Council's response framework which uses a gold, silver and bronze management structure. For hot weather incidents in the local authority area, it is anticipated that the command and control structure will operate from a Silver Group level.

The Silver chair will be provided by Public Health, but in the absence of this, the DPH can request an alternative chair by contacting the EMT to identify a nominated Silver Commander. It may be the case that a Silver Group is required to deal with wider consequence management from extreme temperatures alongside the health impacts. In this case, a discussion will take place between the EMT and the Public Health Team to determine the most appropriate chair for the meetings.

The Silver chair will report into the nominated Gold Commander or relevant senior manager if the Gold Group is not activated. The Silver chair will take on the role of the Emergency Control Centre (ECC) manager should the Silver Group sit physically, and it is determined that an ECC is required. The Silver chair is also expected to represent the Council at an Island Tactical Coordinating Group if this is also established.

The agenda for the Silver Group meetings can be found in the Council's ERRP. The Silver Group chair will be supported by the EMT through the Emergency Management Duty Officer (EMDO) in the initial stages of the response. The structure of the Silver Group will meet the needs of the response in terms of the cells that need to be established and for which a description can be found in the ERRP. When the Silver Group is established a walk-through of arrangements will be undertaken to understand what is needed. Further details on the role of Council Directorates in responding to a Heat Health Alert can be found in section 4. Information on the role of the chair and Silver Group members as part of the command and control structures, when these are activated, can be found in the Council's ERRP.

3.3.2 Multi-Agency Response Arrangements

Should these be established, multi-agency structures will be coordinated through the Hampshire and Isle of Wight Local Resilience Forum (HIOW LRF) as per the ERRP. For the purposes of a hot weather incident, it is unlikely that it will affect the Isle of Wight in isolation to the rest of Hampshire. On this basis, the only response structures likely to be utilised are the HIOW LRF Partners Activation Teleconference (PAT), although if deemed necessary Island based responders can also convene an Island Partners Activation Teleconference (IPAT) during the initial stages of the response and the Island Tactical Co-ordinating Group (ITCG) which will feed Island based information into the HIOW LRF Strategic Co-ordinating Group (SCG) if this is activated.

3.4 Stand Down

The EMDO will inform staff via the cascade when the Heat-Health alert level is reduced.

If activated, the decision to stand down the Silver Group response will be taken by the Silver Group Chair in consultation with the Silver Group members. At this point consideration will be given to whether any formal recovery arrangements need to continue or whether any recovery activities can be dealt with under business-as-usual arrangements. Any requirement for formal recovery arrangements will be undertaken in line with Section 10 of the Council's ERRP.

3.5 Debrief and lesson identification

Following an amber or red Heat Health Alert which has impacted significantly on services and departments within the Council, an internal Council debrief should be considered based upon the level of impact experienced to ensure actions were taken by each Department to identify any areas where improvements could be made, or good practice shared with internal or external colleagues. The health impact of the response should be specifically reviewed with a view to measuring impact. This will be facilitated by the Public Health / Emergency Management Team (EMT). This should be completed within 6 weeks following the incident in line with the Council's ERRP.

Multi-agency debriefs will be carried out in accordance with the HIOW LRF Debrief Guide, and a nominated Council Officer(s) would be required to attend the debrief, to share good practice, to learn from others and to identify any areas of improvement to the multi-agency response.

3.6 Record keeping

It is important for all staff to keep accurate and comprehensive records of response efforts during any incident. The Council's ERRP and the Council's Corporate document retention policy should be referenced for more information on how to ensure record keeping is done well and that the information kept is useful for the Council's debrief activities.

SECTION 4: ROLE OF COUNCIL DIRECTORATES

The below provides a summary of the key role played by Directorates and Services upon receipt of an Heat Health Alert. The list of actions is not exhaustive, and additional activities may be needed to respond to individual hot weather events.

4.1 Adult Social Care and Housing

There is clear evidence to show that heatwaves have the greatest impact on older people, particularly those aged 75 and over. During the 2003 heatwave in England and Wales there was a 22% increase in mortality amongst the over 75s, and in London there was a 59% increase in deaths. Mortality rates amongst older people were significantly high across a number of European countries and cities during the 2003 heatwave ([The impact of heatwaves on mortality in 9 European cities](#)).

During the five heat-periods between June and August 2022, 56,303 deaths occurred in England and Wales. The 2022 heat-period with the largest number of excess deaths was the second heat-period (10 to 25 July), with 2,227 excess deaths (information from [Office for National Statistics](#)). The available evidence demonstrates that those with existing health conditions, low economic status and levels of education, and who live in urban environments are also at increased risk of suffering from the adverse effects of heatwaves.

Adult Social Care and Housing provide market oversight and quality assurance of providers as commissioners of social care. Senior managers are responsible for ensuring that providers and carers of older people are fully aware of their responsibilities at each HHA level so that when a heatwave is forecast, actions can be initiated to protect the vulnerable in their care.

4.2 Children's Services

Children are at increased risk of suffering from the harmful effects of heat because they are dependent on adults to mitigate the harmful effects of heat. This is particularly applicable to the very young as they are less capable of adopting adaptive behaviours during periods of hot weather. As respiratory disease is one of the main causes of heat-related mortality, e.g. asthma, some children may be at increased risk of suffering from the adverse effects of heatwaves.

Senior managers in Children's Services are responsible for ensuring that the carers of children and young people under direct care of the Council are fully aware of their responsibilities at each HHA level so that when a heatwave is forecast, actions can be initiated to protect the vulnerable in their care.

4.3 Communications and Engagement

The Communications and Engagement Team is responsible for working with Public Health and Emergency Management colleagues, as well as any relevant Council Service, to ensure awareness of the health impact of heat and of the actions that can help to mitigate these impacts are raised both before and during a heatwave. Key Public Health messages need to target:

- i. Council staff and Members as appropriate, through a range of mechanisms such as the Vine.
- ii. Public, via press releases, social media and other Council led external communications channels.
- iii. Services either commissioned or provided by the Council
- iv. Media, via pre-scripted media releases (see [Appendix 4](#)).
- v. Press enquiries

The Communications and Engagement Team liaise with the Isle of Wight NHS Trust and Hampshire and Isle of Wight Integrated Care Board to support a coherent, system-wide response.

4.4 Public Health

The Public Health team has a key role in advising and supporting the Council and partners to reduce avoidable excess deaths due to heat. The fundamental tool for achieving this is to raise awareness of the health impact of heat and of the actions that can help to mitigate these impacts amongst both colleagues and the public to ensure that, what may seem obvious to some, is actually being done for those who may not or cannot do it for themselves.

Long-term, all year-round planning is beneficial not only in the event of a heatwave but can also be used for other 'rising tide' type incidents such as severe cold weather, snow, pandemic influenza etc. Heatwave planning may also be considered in the development of Joint Strategic Needs Assessments for the Health and Wellbeing Board. It is important that the Local Health Resilience Partnership (LHRP) ensures that all partners are fully engaged, and planning is co-ordinated across both acute and commissioned services as well as UKHSA and the Local Authority. In addition, Public Health colleagues work collaboratively with the other Directorates and Services to reduce further climate change and mitigate impact of changes in climate, which include increased frequency and intensity of heatwaves.

The main responsibility for Local Authority Director of Public Health (DPH) is one of assurance of system actions and to ensure that key Public Health messages are coordinated and widely published to raise awareness of both the public and those who care for groups more vulnerable to the health impacts of increased heat. In order to achieve timely and accurate communication of key Public Health messages, Public Health works closely with the Communications and Engagement Team and partners to present the information in the appropriate way for each population group.

During all HHA levels, Public Health will monitor the surveillance data published by UKHSA which is based on real time information such as numbers of calls to NHS111, GP in and out of hours consultations and Emergency Department attendances. This data identifies the impact of heat-related morbidity using a range of syndromic health indicators, which allows Local Authorities to compare themselves with other Authorities in the region and benchmark against the England average.

4.5 Emergency Management Team

The Emergency Management Team (EMT) play a key role in the response and recovery from incidents or emergencies affecting Island residents. This team is responsible for developing the Council's ERRP and plays an important role in providing input into HLOW LRF plans that may be activated in response to an adverse weather event. EMT will forward any HHAs issued to Council staff using the designated distribution list as outlined in Section 3. EMT will also support with any response arrangements that need to be activated in response to a HHA, as well as the recovery and debrief phase of a response.

4.6 Community Services

Community Services is the Council's Directorate for highways, waste management, leisure facilities, and licensing of events. Consideration should be given to large scale public events where the public's exposure to heat and direct sunlight may be increased. Community Services will work closely with Public Health and the Communications and Engagement Team to ensure that any messaging shared with public spaces and events is consistent with local and national communications.

4.7 Other Council Services and Directorates

In addition to the specific roles and responsibilities of the Directorates and Services named above, there are actions for staff across the Council. These include ensuring staff welfare in a heatwave and cascading the key Public Health messages to members of the public that they are in contact with.

SECTION 5: APPENDICES

Appendix 1 – Impact of Heat on Health

This section provides information on the direct and indirect impacts of heat on health. It also explores the relationship between heat and two emerging threats: drought and thunderstorm asthma. Finally, there is information on how national agencies monitor the impacts of adverse weather on health and how health officials and the public can view relevant statistics.

A1.1 The effects of heat on health

Who does heat affect?

Those already frail or with long term conditions are particularly vulnerable as even small changes in seasonal temperatures can have serious effects. Medications can also affect temperature regulation and the body's ability to sweat.

Hospitalisations can occur extremely quickly. Death and illness are often seen in the first days of a heatwave. Those most at risk of death or hospitalisation are people with

- Respiratory disease – exacerbation of symptoms due to air pollution, pollen levels
- Cardiovascular disease – strain on the heart due to vasodilation to cool the blood through the skin

Many of the deaths due to excessive heat exposure are preventable if a few very simple precautions are taken to reduce the impact of heat on health.

Extreme heat also impacts those vulnerable to physiological stress and exacerbated illness. These include

- older people aged 65 years and over (note change from previous guidance of 75 years of age and above)
- babies and young children aged 5 years and under
- people with underlying health conditions particularly heart problems, breathing problems, dementia, diabetes, kidney disease, Parkinson's disease, or mobility problems
- people on certain medications
- people with serious mental health problems
- people who are already ill and dehydrated (for example from diarrhea and vomiting)
- people who experience alcohol or drug dependence
- people who are physically active and spend a lot of time outside such as runners, cyclists and walkers
- people who work in jobs that require manual labour or extensive time outside
- people experiencing homelessness, including rough sleepers and those who are unable to make adaptations to their living accommodation such as sofa surfers or living in hostels.
- people who live alone and may be unable to care for themselves

How does heat affect health?

Direct effects

A rise in human body temperature can be caused by a combination of external heat from the environment and from internal metabolic processes. Rapid rises in body temperature compromises the body's ability to regulate temperature and result in a number of illnesses.

- Heat cramps – caused by dehydration and loss of electrolytes, often following exercise
- Heat exhaustion – loss of water and or sodium, symptoms include vomiting and collapse
- Heat oedema – retention of fluid in the ankles
- Heat syncope – dizziness and fainting due to dehydration
- [Heat stroke](#) – this is a medical emergency, the body's thermoregulation fails, leading to confusion, convulsions and unconsciousness. All can lead to cell death, organ failure and death.

If you think someone has heatstroke you should dial 999 and then try to cool them down.

Indirect effects

There is a risk of an impact on health services, due to increased ambulance callouts, hospital admissions and the storage of medicines. Heatwaves increase temperatures in wards affecting patient recovery and staff performance.

Increased risk of accidents is a concern and can include drownings, exposure and injuries due to poor working conditions and poisonings. Drought conditions combined with the temptation to cool off in rivers, reservoirs and lakes can increase the risk of injury and death. Diving into water can cause serious spinal injury due to the water being too shallow and unknown hazards just beneath the surface. Also open water can be much colder than it looks which can lead to [cold water shock](#).

Further [Safe swimming advice](#) is contained in the AWHP.

Warmer temperatures increase the risk of water and food borne diseases. Algal blooms growing on open water sources can release toxins harmful to humans and animals.

A1.2 Emerging Hazard - Drought

Information on drought can be found in the [Adverse Weather and Health Plan: Supporting evidence](#) and [Public health impact of drought: advice for the public](#)

The global frequency of concurrent heat episodes and droughts has increased since the 1950s with strong scientific evidence for this having been driven by human influence. Between 1970 and 2019, more deaths were attributed to drought globally than any other water-related hazard.

As a consequence of the increase in global temperature, the frequency of droughts will increase, causing significant impact on human health and livelihood.

Unlike other adverse weather events such as heat episodes and flooding, droughts have a slow onset. The health effects of droughts are difficult to identify and are also not well understood. Droughts have a direct impact on health as they can affect water quality and quantity, and harm crop yields, impacting access to food supply and nutrition. Droughts also have indirect effects such as impact on vector-borne diseases as they can influence vector habitat, as well as environmental factors by way of biodiversity loss.

The [UKHSA Health Effects of Climate Change in the UK: state of the evidence 2023](#) report states that the UK is vulnerable to multi-season, longer duration hydrological droughts, with the south-east being more vulnerable to multi-year groundwater droughts. The report also highlighted the summer of 2022 as a recent and significant period of drought, when temperatures in England reached 40 degrees Celsius in mid-August. This period also had low levels of rainfall, resulting in it being the fifth driest summer for England and Wales since 1836.

The health consequences are related to dehydration, increase of transmission of infectious diseases and poorer mental health. Droughts can affect people's mental health due to disruption in day-to-day activities, water shortages, damage to property and impact to livelihoods such as farming and agricultural communities by way of loss of crops and livestock. The below diagram summarises the direct (left hand side) and indirect impacts of drought (right hand side).

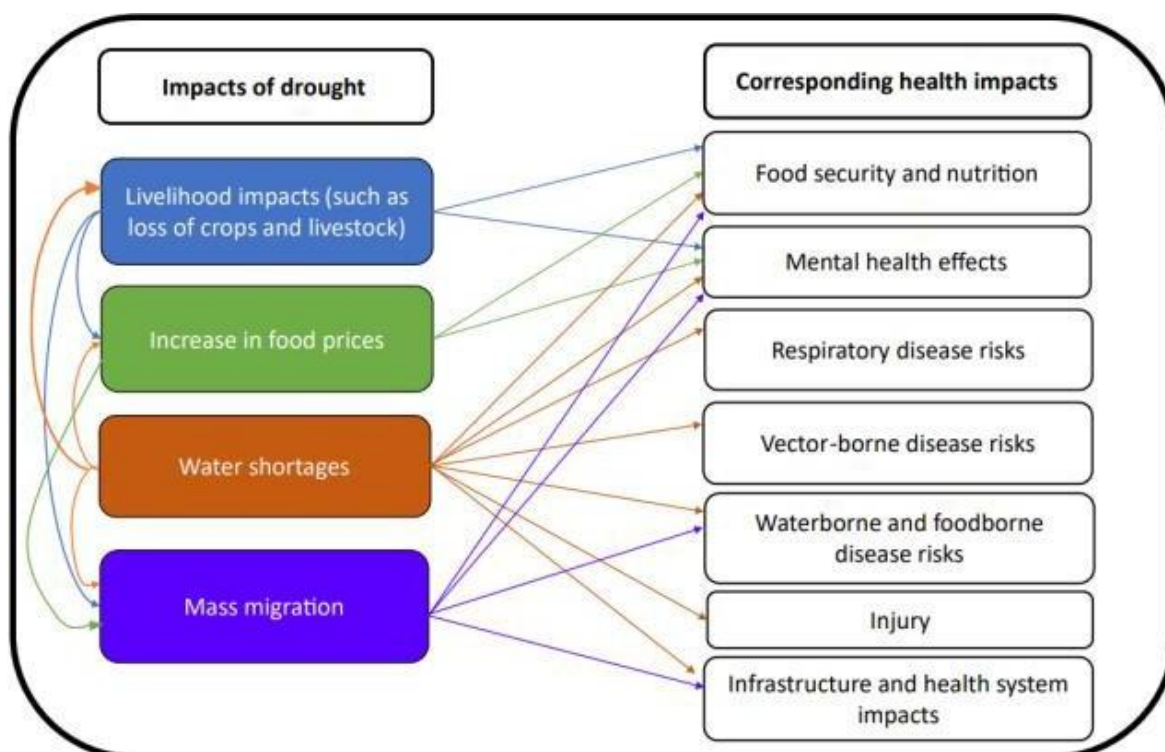


Figure 1. Direct and Indirect Impacts of Drought

Potential negative health impacts from livelihood loss include food shortages, consequential impacts on nutrition and impacts on mental health. Increases in food prices may affect food security, nutrition, and mental health. Water shortages may impact food security, nutrition, mental health, vector-borne disease risk, respiratory disease risks, waterborne and foodborne disease risks, injury and infrastructure and health system impacts. Mass migration may adversely affect food security and nutrition, mental health, waterborne and foodborne disease and infrastructure and health system impacts.

During periods of drought, the [Public health impact of drought: advice for the public](#) recommends following restrictions on the use of water such as hosepipe bans and use water efficiently, sign up to the water companies Priority Services Register (PSR), maintain hygiene during a drought period, stay hydrated and look after your mental health. DPH should consider the impact of drought in broader risk assessment.

A1.3 Emerging Hazard - Thunderstorm Asthma

Severe summer storms, including thunderstorms, can occur throughout the warmer months. They also present the potential for health impacts, known as thunderstorm asthma which is a term used to describe any observed increase in acute bronchospasm cases following the occurrence of thunderstorms in the local vicinity. Evidence suggests that those most at risk during these events are younger in age, those with asthma (both diagnosed and undiagnosed) and allergic rhinitis. Episodes of thunderstorm asthma can occur during peak grass and fungal spore season (June and July). This can result in a surge in patients needing emergency healthcare services with exacerbated symptoms of asthma. Thunderstorm asthma events have been detected by UKHSA syndromic surveillance systems over the past 3 summers.

UKHSA is currently working with colleagues across government and with academic partners to further understanding of thunderstorm asthma events, who is at risk and what actions can be taken to prevent these episodes. DPH should consider the impact of asthma in broader risk assessment.

A1.4 Health Monitoring and Surveillance

During the Heat-Health Watch (1 June – 15 September) UKHSA monitors syndromic surveillance systems to allow early alerting and near real-time reporting on health conditions and mortality surveillance to provide timely data on deaths during heatwaves. UKHSA produces three key mortality reports for the Department of Health and data are also published in an [on-line tool](#) which allows Local Authorities to compare themselves with others in the region and the England average. This tool assists Local Authorities in benchmarking how well the public's health is being improved and protected against the outcomes and indicators in the Public Health Outcomes Framework. Several outcome indicators can be linked to long-term planning for severe heat and heatwaves.

Appendix 2 – Email template for a Yellow or Amber Heat-Health Alerts (HHA)

Note: EMDO to amend highlighted sections and include information provided in Met Office alert.

For the attention of the Council senior duty officers, Public Health Team, and previously nominated service contacts from local authority services.

Please find attached the latest details from UKHSA advising of a [insert level] Heat- Health Alert (HHA).

Yellow alerts are issued during periods of heat which would be unlikely to impact most people but could impact those who are particularly vulnerable.

OR

An **amber alert** indicates that weather impacts are likely to be felt across the whole health service, with potential for the whole population to be at risk.

The [insert level] HHA is in effect between [insert start date and time] and [insert end date and time] in the South East of England. *Add in any relevant general comments here*

Please can you ensure that your relevant staff are made aware of this message and their responsibilities as set out in the:

IWC Heatwave Plan

- Appendix 5: Suggested actions for commissioners
- Appendix 6: Suggested actions for health and social care
- Appendix 7: suggested actions for community, voluntary sector, and individuals

These are complemented by the UKHSA National Adverse Weather and Health Plan action cards which are publicly available:

- [Heat-Health Alert action card for commissioners - GOV.UK \(www.gov.uk\)](https://www.gov.uk/government/uploads/system/uploads/attachment_data/file/674444/Heat-Health_Alert_action_card_for_commissioners.pdf)
- [Heat-Health Alert action card for providers - GOV.UK \(www.gov.uk\)](https://www.gov.uk/government/uploads/system/uploads/attachment_data/file/674444/Heat-Health_Alert_action_card_for_providers.pdf)
- [Heat-Health Alert action card for the voluntary and community sector - GOV.UK \(www.gov.uk\)](https://www.gov.uk/government/uploads/system/uploads/attachment_data/file/674444/Heat-Health_Alert_action_card_for_the_voluntary_and_community_sector.pdf)

Additional Action to Cascade Alert:

- **Health and Social Care commissioners**, please can you ensure that this is distributed to providers and voluntary sector organisations and that you provide them with a designated point of contact should they require any advice or support.
- **IWC Licensing**, please can you pass on details of the HHA to the event organisers of any large events taking place within the warning period and signpost to the following: [Events and mass gatherings guidance](#)

- **IWC Comms**, please can you liaise with NHS Communications and **Public Health** to put a joint release out (suggested messages are contained in Appendix 4 of the IWC Heatwave plan and within the [Adverse Weather and Health Plan](#)) through the usual channels.

- **Premises Development**, please can you distribute this message to schools for them to consider any actions that they may wish to take considering the forecast (unless alert falls within school holiday) and signpost to this guidance: [Looking after children and those in early years settings before and during hot weather: teachers and other educational professionals - GOV.UK \(www.gov.uk\)](#)

Emergency Management will be liaising with key Council service areas and multi-agency partners to ensure a coordinated approach should the situation escalate.

We will continue to monitor the situation and issue updates as necessary.

Kind regards,

Emergency Management Duty Officer

Appendix 3 – Email for Red Warnings

Note: EMDO to amend highlighted sections and include information provided in Met Office alert.

For the attention of the Council senior duty officers, Public Health Team, and previously nominated service contacts from local authority services.

Please find attached the latest details from UKHSA advising of a Red Heat-Health Alert (Emergency). Severe impacts are expected across the health and social care sector due to the high temperatures. A red alert indicates significant risk to life for the healthy population.

The Red Heat-Health Alert (HHA) is in effect between **[insert start date and time]** and **[insert end date and time]** in the South East of England. **Add in any relevant general comments here**

Please can you ensure that your relevant staff are made aware of this message and their responsibilities as set out in the:

IWC Heatwave Plan

- Appendix 5: Suggested actions for commissioners
- Appendix 6: Suggested actions for health and social care
- Appendix 7: suggested actions for community, voluntary sector, and individuals

These are complemented by the UKHSA National Adverse Weather and Health Plan action cards which are publicly available:

- [Heat-Health Alert action card for commissioners - GOV.UK \(www.gov.uk\)](https://www.gov.uk/government/uploads/system/uploads/attachment_data/file/674442/Heat-Health_Alert_action_card_for_commissioners.pdf)
- [Heat-Health Alert action card for providers - GOV.UK \(www.gov.uk\)](https://www.gov.uk/government/uploads/system/uploads/attachment_data/file/674443/Heat-Health_Alert_action_card_for_providers.pdf)
- [Heat-Health Alert action card for the voluntary and community sector - GOV.UK \(www.gov.uk\)](https://www.gov.uk/government/uploads/system/uploads/attachment_data/file/674444/Heat-Health_Alert_action_card_for_the_voluntary_and_community_sector.pdf)

Additional Action to Cascade Alert:

- **Health and Social Care commissioners**, please can you ensure that this is distributed to providers and voluntary sector organisations and that you provide them with a designated point of contact should they require any advice or support.
- **IWC Licensing**, please can you pass on details of the HHA to the event organisers of any large events taking place within the warning period and signpost to the following: [Events and mass gatherings guidance](#)
- **IWC Comms**, please can you liaise with NHS Communications and **Public Health** to put a joint release out (suggested messages are contained in Appendix 4 of the IWC Heatwave Plan and within the [Adverse Weather and Health Plan](#)) through the usual channels.
- **Premises Development**, please can you distribute this message to schools for them to consider any actions that they may wish to take considering the forecast (unless alert falls within school holidays), and signpost to this guidance: [Looking after children and those in early years settings before and during hot weather: teachers and other educational professionals -](#)

[GOV.UK \(www.gov.uk\)](https://www.gov.uk). Can you liaise with the schools and **IWC Comms** to ensure that details of any schools which decide to close during this period can be communicated to the public.

Emergency Management will continue to liaise with key Council service areas and multi-agency partners to ensure a coordinated approach in responding to impacts resulting from heatwave conditions.

We will continue to monitor the situation and issue updates as necessary.

Kind regards,

Emergency Management Duty Officer

Appendix 4 – Public Health Communications on Hot Weather

What do we need to do?

Section 2 of this plan sets out the levels of response that range through long term planning, preparedness, alert and readiness to action from the AWHP.

Section 3 in this plan gives the levels of response from the Isle of Wight Council.

Core public health messages need to be cascaded to all local authority services. These messages to be broadcast as official UKHSA warnings alongside national and regional weather forecasts.

Example messages

Green – Summer preparedness and long-term planning

No alert will be issued as the conditions are likely to have minimal impact on health; business as usual and summer/winter planning and preparedness activities

Yellow - Alert and readiness

UKHSA, is issuing the following heat-health advice for **[insert regions identified]**: “Stay out of the sun. Keep your home as cool as possible – shading windows and shutting them during the day may help. Open them when it is cooler at night. Keep drinking fluids. If there’s anybody you know, for example an older person living on their own who might be at special risk, make sure they know what to do.”

“If this does turn out to be a heatwave, we will try to give you as much warning as possible. But in the meantime, if you are worried about what to do either for yourself or somebody you know who you think might be at risk, for advice go to the NHS website at

[Heatwave: how to cope in hot weather - NHS \(www.nhs.uk\)](https://www.nhs.uk)

[Sunscreen and sun safety - NHS \(www.nhs.uk\)](https://www.nhs.uk)

Alternatively ring NHS 111

Further information can be found here:

[Beat the heat: keep cool at home checklist - GOV.UK \(www.gov.uk\)](https://www.gov.uk)

[Beat the Heat \(publishing.service.gov.uk\)](https://publishing.service.gov.uk)

Amber and Red - Heatwave action/ emergency – Draft Press Release

UKHSA, is issuing the following heat-health warning for *[insert regions identified]*:

Councillor **X**, Cabinet Member for Public Health said: *"insert quote."*

Example quote

“It’s getting hotter again this week with temperatures predicted to reach the mid-thirties over several days on some parts of the Island. These periods of extremely high heat that we are experiencing this summer could be particularly challenging for the more vulnerable people in our communities. It is important we look after ourselves as well as loved ones and anyone who might be at risk, such as the elderly, those with underlying health conditions or the very young.”

The advice for residents is to follow the guidance for staying safe and well in hot weather.

Stay out of the heat

- Keep out of the sun between 11.00am and 3.00pm - if you must go out in the heat, walk in the shade, apply sunscreen and wear a hat and light scarf
- Avoid extreme physical exertion
- Wear light, loose-fitting cotton clothes

Cool yourself down

- Have plenty of cold drinks, avoid alcohol, caffeine and hot drinks, and eat cold foods, particularly salads and fruit with a high-water content
- Take a cool shower, bath or body wash, or sprinkle water over the skin or clothing, or keep a damp cloth on the back of your neck

Keep your environment cool

- Keep your living space cool - place a thermometer in your main living room and bedroom to keep a check on the temperature
- Keep windows that are exposed to the sun closed during the day and open windows at night when the temperature has dropped - close curtains that receive morning or afternoon sun
- Turn off non-essential lights and electrical equipment - they generate heat

What to do if you or someone you know is unwell

Dehydration, heat exhaustion and heatstroke can affect anyone during a heatwave, even people who are usually fit and well. Babies and young children, older people, and people with underlying health conditions are particularly vulnerable to the effects of hot weather.

Those who work outdoors should try to stay out of the sun and take measures to protect skin against sun exposure, keep cool and stay hydrated.

For more information on heat-related illnesses and what to do should you or someone you know feel unwell visit NHS. Call NHS 111 or a GP if you or someone you know is unwell. Call 999 in an emergency.

Travel advice

Follow the AA's advice when planning to travel to avoid congestion and for tips for keeping everyone cool in hot cars, including dogs, as well as spotting poorly passengers.

If you are attending a festival or other event, take extra precautions to stay well in hot weather.

Additional Core Public Health Messages

The above press release has been drafted based on core public health messages from the [UKHSA Adverse Weather and Health Plan](#) and can be used to supplement the press release as appropriate.

Stay out of the heat:

- Keep out of the sun at the hottest time of the day, between 11.00am and 3.00pm.
- If you have to go out in the heat, walk in the shade, apply [sunscreen](#) and wear a hat and light scarf.
- Avoid extreme physical exertion. If you are going to do a physical activity (exercise or walking the dog) plan to do these in the morning or evening when it is cooler.
- Wear light, loose-fitting cotton clothes.

Cool yourself down:

- Have plenty of [fluids](#), and avoid excess alcohol, caffeine and hot drinks.
- Eat cold foods, particularly salads and fruit with a high-water content.
- Take a cool shower, bath or body wash.
- Sprinkle water over the skin or clothing, or keep a damp cloth on the back of your neck.

Keep your environment cool:

- Keeping your living space cool is especially important for infants, the elderly or those with chronic health conditions or who can't look after themselves.
- Place a thermometer in your main living room and bedroom to keep a check on the temperature.
- Keep windows that are exposed to the sun closed during the day, and open windows at night when the temperature has dropped.

- Close curtains that receive morning or afternoon sun. However, care should be taken with metal blinds and dark curtains, as these can absorb heat – consider replacing or putting reflective material in-between them and the window space.
- Turn off non-essential lights and electrical equipment – they generate heat.
- Keep indoor plants and bowls of water in the house as evaporation helps cool the air.
- If possible, move into a cooler room, especially for sleeping.
- Electric fans may provide some relief, if temperatures are below 35°C.¹

Look out for others:

- keep an eye on isolated, elderly, ill or very young people and make sure they are able to keep cool
- ensure that babies, children or elderly people are not left alone in [stationary cars](#)
- check on elderly or sick neighbours, family or friends every day during a heatwave
- be alert and call a doctor or social services if someone is unwell or further help is needed

If you have a health problem:

- keep medicines below 25 °C or in the refrigerator (read the storage instructions on the packaging)
- seek medical advice if you are suffering from a chronic medical condition or taking multiple medications
- be aware of medications that might affect your ability to regulate body temperature

If you or others feel unwell:

- know the symptoms of [heat exhaustion and heatstroke](#)
- **If you think someone has heatstroke you should dial 999 and then try to cool them down**
- try to get help if you feel dizzy, weak, anxious or have intense thirst and headache, move to a cool place as soon as possible and measure your body temperature
- drink some water or fruit juice to rehydrate
- rest immediately in a cool place if you have painful muscular spasms (particularly in the legs, arms or abdomen, in many cases after sustained exercise during very hot weather), and drink oral rehydration solutions containing electrolytes.
- medical attention is needed if heat cramps last more than one hour
- consult your doctor if you feel unusual symptoms or if symptoms persist

Further information can be found here:

[Beat the heat: staying safe in hot weather - GOV.UK \(www.gov.uk\)](#)

[Beat the heat: keep cool at home checklist - GOV.UK \(www.gov.uk\)](#)

¹ NOTE: Use of Fans: At temperatures above 35 degrees Celsius fans may not prevent heat related illness. Additionally, fans can cause excess dehydration (Cochrane Review). The advice is to place the fan at a certain distance from people, not aiming it directly on the body and to have regular drinks. This is especially important in the case of sick people confined to bed.

Appendix 5 - Suggested actions for commissioners of health and social care (all settings) and local authority Directors of Public Health.

This Appendix should be read in conjunction with the AWHP action cards

- [Heat-Health Alert action card for commissioners - GOV.UK \(www.gov.uk\)](https://www.gov.uk/government/uploads/system/uploads/attachment_data/file/614440/Heat-Health_Alert_action_card_for_commissioners_-_GOV.UK.pdf)
- [Heat-Health Alert summary action card for commissioners](#)

Council Response Level	Descriptor	Actions
1	<u>Preparedness</u> Actions to consider all year round to support summer preparedness and during the heat-health watch period, 1 June to 15 September.	Working with other departments within the Isle of Wight Council, partner agencies at multi-agency forums, incorporating agreements into joint strategic plans to prepare for and mitigate the impact of heatwaves, including the following: • How to identify and improve the resilience of those individuals and communities most at risk¹. • Work with partner agencies, providers and businesses to coordinate heatwave plans and Business Continuity Plans (BCPs), ensuring vulnerable marginalised groups are appropriately supported. • Ensure all relevant staff are aware and understand BCPs and heatwave plans and have received training where appropriate • Ensuring that a local, joined-up programme is in place covering: - o Housing, loft and wall insulation and other plans to reduce internal energy use and heat production. - o Environmental action (e.g. increase trees and green spaces; external shading; reflective paint; water features). - o Other infrastructure changes (e.g. porous pavements). - o Engaging the community and voluntary sector to support the development of local emergency plans. • Making progress on relevant Public Health outcome framework indicators • Ensuring the Isle of Wight NHS Trust and care homes are aware of the UKHSA AWHP, literature and guidance available to them and are engaged in preparing for heatwaves. • Engage the community and voluntary sector to support communities to help those most at risk.

¹ High-risk groups:

Community: over 75, female, living on own and isolated, severe physical or mental illness; urban areas, south-facing top flat; alcohol and/or drug dependency, homeless, babies and young children, multiple medications and over-exertion

Care home or hospital: over 75, female, frail, severe physical or mental illness; multiple medications; babies and young children (hospitals).

		• Ensure other institutional establishments such as Her Majesty's Prison Isle of Wight and local schools are aware of the AWHP, and that there is awareness of the guidance on Emergency planning and response for education, childcare, and children's social care settings - GOV.UK (www.gov.uk). • Ensure organisers of large events such as festivals and sporting events take account of possible heat risks.
2*	<u>Response</u> These alerts cover a range of situations. Yellow alerts may be issued during periods of heat which would be unlikely to impact most people but could impact those who are particularly vulnerable.	• Emergency Management to communicate Yellow HHA email alert (Appendix 2) to all nominated service contacts and make sure that they are aware of the AWHP and Council plan. • Work with partners and staff on risk reduction awareness (e.g. key public health messages – Appendix 4) by using a variety of communication methods to maximise dissemination. • Implement BCPs where required. • Increase advice to health and social care workers in the community, care homes and local hospital. • Ensure organisers of large events take account of heat risks. • Continue to engage with the community and voluntary sector to help those most at risk.
3**	<u>Enhanced Response</u> An amber alert indicates that weather impacts are likely to be felt across the whole health service, with potential for the whole population to be at risk. Non-health sectors may also start to	• Emergency Management to communicate Amber HHA email alert (Appendix 2) to all nominated service contacts and make sure that they are aware of the AWHP and Council plan. • Implement BCPs • Media alerts about keeping cool (See Appendix 4). • Review safety of public events. • Mobilise community and voluntary support (e.g. British Red Cross, 4x4 clubs) if necessary. • Ensure that commissioned services are checking vulnerable clients identified as high risk and taking remedial actions as shown in appendix 6 and 7. • Consider the need to set up Silver Command • Participation by EMT and PH in LRF Structures if set up and consideration of setting up IRF Structure if appropriate i.e. likely to move to a Red HHA.

	observe impacts and amore significant coordinated response may be required.	
4***	<u>Emergency Response</u> A red alert indicates significant risk to life for even the healthy population	National emergency Central government will declare a Red HHA alert in the event of a severe or prolonged heatwave affecting sectors other than health and if requiring a coordinated multi-agency response. • Continue actions as per amber level unless advised to the contrary. • Set up Silver Command • Participation by EMT and PH in LRF Structures and IRF, where these are set up
5	Stand down and recovery	• Emergency Management will inform staff via the cascade when the HHA period has ended • A move to business-as-usual activities • IWC EMT and PH to consider convening debrief meeting and capturing lessons learnt

*Because Level 2 is based on a prediction, there may be jumps between levels.

** Following Level 3, wait until temperatures cool to Level 1 before stopping Level 3 actions.

*** Level 4: A decision to issue a Level 4 alert at national level will be taken in light of a cross- government assessment of the weather conditions, coordinated by the Civil Contingencies Secretariat

Appendix 6 – Suggested actions for health and social care providers and staff in all settings (community, hospitals and care homes)

This Appendix should be read in conjunction with the AWHP action cards

- [Heat-Health Alert action card for providers](#)
- [Heat-Health Alert summary action card for services delivering care to people in their homes](#)
- [Heat-Health Alert summary action card for hospitals and healthcare in the community](#)
- [Heat-Health Alert summary action card for care homes and other adult social care residential settings](#)

Council Response Level	Descriptor	Actions
1	<u>Preparedness</u> Actions to consider all year round to support summer preparedness and during the heat-health watch period 1 June to 15 September.	Professional staff (all settings): • Develop systems to identify and improve resilience of high-risk individuals¹ and raise awareness of heat illnesses and their prevention among clients and carers (see key public health messages in Appendix 4) • Include risk in care records and consider whether changes might be necessary to care homes in the event of a heatwave (e.g. initiating daily visits by formal or informal care givers of those living alone). • Develop a training plan to ensure staff are aware of the local heatwave plans, Business Continuity Plans (BCPs) and are prepared for hot weather • Request a housing health and safety rating assessment (HHSRS) from Environmental Health for clients at particular risk. • Encourage cycling/walking where possible to reduce heat levels and poor air quality in urban areas. Care homes and hospitals: • Work with commissioners to develop longer term plans to prepare for heatwaves. • Make environmental improvements to produce a safe environment for clients in the event of a heatwave.

¹ High-risk groups:

Community: over 75, female, living on own and isolated, severe physical or mental illness; urban areas, south-facing top flat; alcohol and/or drug dependency, homeless, babies and young children, multiple medications and over-exertion

Care home or hospital: over 75, female, frail, severe physical or mental illness; multiple medications; babies and young children (hospitals).

		• Ensure BCPs are in place to cover the event of a heatwave (e.g. storage of medicines, computer resilience etc) and implement as required; ensure appropriate contract details are provided to local authority/National Health Service emergency planning officers to facilitate transfer of emergency information. • Work with partners and staff to raise awareness of the impacts of severe heat and on risk reduction awareness (see key public health messages in Appendix 4) • Identify or create cool rooms/areas (able to be maintained below 26 degrees) • Install thermometers where vulnerable individuals spend substantial time
2*	<u>Response</u> These alerts cover a range of situations. Yellow alerts may be issued during periods of heat which would be unlikely to impact most people but could impact those who are particularly vulnerable.	Professional staff (all settings): • Check high-risk people have visitor/phone call arrangements in place. • Reconfirm key public health messages to clients. • Check client's room temperature if visiting. Care homes and hospitals: • Check indoor temperatures are recorded regularly during the hottest periods for all areas where patients reside. • Ensure cool areas are below 26°C . • Review and prioritise high-risk people. • Ensure efficient cold water and ice supplies • Consider weighing clients regularly to identify dehydration and rescheduling physiotherapy to cooler hours. • Communicate alerts to staff and make sure that they are aware of and understand heatwave plans. • Ensure sufficient staffing. • Implement BCP's.
3**	<u>Enhanced Response</u> An amber alert indicates that weather impacts are likely to be felt across the whole health	Professional staff (all settings): • Visit/phone high-risk people. • Reconfirm key public health messages to clients. • Advise carers to contact GP if there are concerns regarding health. Care homes and hospitals: • Activate plans to maintain business continuity – including a possible surge in demand. • Check indoor temperatures are recorded regularly during the hottest periods for all areas where patients reside.

	service, with potential for the whole population to be at risk. Non-health sectors may also start to observe impacts and a more significant coordinated response may be required.	• Ensure staff can help and advise clients including access to cool rooms, close monitoring of vulnerable individuals, reducing shading, turning off unnecessary lights/equipment. • Ensure discharge planning takes home temperatures and support into account
4***	<u>Emergency Response</u>	National emergency • Continue actions as per Amber level unless advised to the contrary.

*Because Level 2 is based on a prediction, there may be jumps between levels.

** Following Level 3, wait until temperatures cool to Level 1 before stopping Level 3 actions.

*** Level 4: A decision to issue a Level 4 alert at national level will be taken in light of a cross-government assessment of the weather conditions, coordinated by the Civil Contingencies Secretariat

Appendix 7 - Suggested actions for community and voluntary sector and individuals

This Appendix should be read in conjunction with the AWHP action cards

- [Heat-Health Alert action card for the voluntary and community sector](#)
- [Heat-Health Alert summary action card for the voluntary and community sector](#)

Council Response Level	Descriptor	Actions
1	<u>Preparedness</u> Actions to consider all year round to support summer preparedness and during the heat-health watch period, 1 June to 15 September.	Community groups: • Develop a community emergency plan to identify and support vulnerable neighbours in the event of a heatwave. • Ensure relevant staff are aware of and understand the community emergency plan including ensuring staff have received training where applicable • Assess the impact a heatwave might have on the provision and use of usual community venues. • Support those at-risk¹ to make sure they are receiving the benefits they are entitled to. • Support the provision of good information about health risks especially with those vulnerable groups and individuals (see Key Public Health Messages in Appendix 4). Individuals: • Make environmental improvements inside and outside the house which reduce internal energy and heat. • Install loft and wall insulation. • Identify cool areas in the house to use in the event of a heatwave. • If on medication, ensure that these can be stored at safe levels in a heatwave. • Find good information about health risks and key public health messages to stay healthy during spells of severe heat. • Look out for vulnerable neighbours.

¹ High-risk groups:

Community: over 75, female, living on own and isolated, severe physical or mental illness; urban areas, south-facing top flat; alcohol and/or drug dependency, homeless, babies and young children, multiple medications and over-exertion

Care home or hospital: over 75, female, frail, severe physical or mental illness; multiple medications; babies and young children (hospitals).

2*	<u>Response</u> These alerts cover a range of situations. Yellow alerts may be issued during periods of heat which would be unlikely to impact most people but could impact those who are particularly vulnerable.	Community groups: • Keep an eye on people you know to be at risk¹. Support the provision of good information about health risks especially with those vulnerable groups and individuals (see Key Public Health Messages in Appendix 4). • Monitor weather forecasts and keep stocked up with food and medication. • Create cool rooms – able to be maintained below 26 degrees Individuals: • Monitor weather forecasts. • Check ambient room temperatures – especially those rooms where disabled or high-risk individuals spend most of their time. • Keep an eye on people you know to be at risk – ensure they have access to plenty of cool liquids. • Look out for vulnerable neighbours.
3**	<u>Enhanced Response</u> An amber alert indicates that weather impacts are likely to be felt across the whole health service, with potential for the whole population to be at risk. Non-health sectors may also start to observe impacts and a more significant coordinated response may be required.	Community groups: • Activate community emergency plan. • Check those you know are at risk. Individuals: • Follow key public health messages. • Check those you know are at risk.

4***	<u>Emergency response</u> A red alert indicates significant risk to life for even the healthy population	National emergency Continue actions as per Amber unless advised to the contrary.
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*Because Level 2 is based on a prediction, there may be jumps between levels.

** Following Level 3, wait until temperatures cool to Level 1 before stopping Level 3 actions.

** Level 4: A decision to issue a Level 4 alert at national level will be taken in light of a cross-government assessment of the weather conditions, coordinated by the Civil Contingencies Secretariat

Appendix 8 – Links to National Guidance and Action Cards

It is vitally important that the [UKHSA Adverse Weather and Health Plan](#) is referred to for detailed guidance and actions to take in response to hot weather. There are also a number of guidance sheets on preventing harm including guidance on coping with heat available for use by the public and a number of services and organisations.

A8.1 Advice for the public

The following links provide documents which contain self-help advice and advice for those looking after others during hot weather:

[Beat the heat: hot weather advice - GOV.UK \(www.gov.uk\)](#)

The NHS website provides additional general summer advice including advice on heatstroke and other heat-related conditions:

[Heatwave: how to cope in hot weather - NHS \(www.nhs.uk\)](#)

[Sunscreen and sun safety - NHS \(www.nhs.uk\)](#)

The public can phone NHS 111 or their GP if they are concerned about their health or others. Further details and example press releases for public dissemination can be found in [Appendix 4](#).

A8.2 Advice for local authority services

Detailed guidance can be found by clicking on the following links:

Advice for health and social care professionals:

The following action cards are provided nationally and summarise advice on how different organisations need to respond to heat-health alert levels.

- [Heat-Health Alert action card for commissioners](#)
- [Heat-Health Alert action card for providers](#)
- [Heat-Health Alert action card for the voluntary and community sector](#)

Summary action cards, available as posters, have also been produced nationally:

- [Heat-Health Alert summary action card for the voluntary and community sector](#)
- [Heat-Health Alert summary action card for commissioners](#)

- [Heat-Health Alert summary action card for services delivering care to people in their homes](#)
- [Heat-Health Alert summary action card for hospitals and healthcare in the community](#)
- [Heat-Health Alert summary action card for care homes and other adult social care residential settings](#)

Advice for looking after school children and those in an early year's settings:

[Looking after children and those in early years settings before and during hot weather: teachers and other educational professionals - GOV.UK \(www.gov.uk\)](#)

Advice for heatwaves and mass gatherings/large public events:

[Hot weather advice: planning events and mass gatherings - GOV.UK \(www.gov.uk\)](#)

[Guidance on running events safely](#)